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Problem Statement: To grow Meesho's C2M seller base and its long-term contribution to price competitiveness.

meesho SEASON 3 DICE CHALLENGE

Segmentation & Personas

The Setup

"Made in India" now comes with 3 extra steps: resold in India, re-resold in India, and re-re-resold in India.

What buyers want?



Efficient Delivery

Value for money

interviews

Fair return options

Optimal Quality

What manufacturers need?



Demand certainty

No single-parcel hassle

interviews

Less working capital stuck

A price that clears cost

What Meesho needs?

Sellers with real cost edge

A listing that surfaces

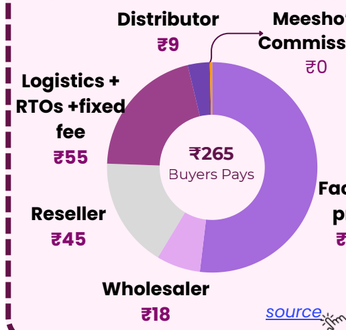
A spec that stays honest

Stock that holds

PROBLEM EXPLANATION

- Most large manufacturers never sell on Meesho, and those who try rarely stay.
- Single-parcel listing and dispatch don't fit a bulk factory, and the first 30 days bring too few orders to keep going.
- The lower prices they could offer buyers are lost to resellers.
- The task: grow Meesho's manufacturer base so prices fall, without subsidies or handholding that can't scale.

COST BREAKDOWN



source

Price

CURRENT PRICE ₹ 265

C2M PRICE ₹ 205

₹ 60 extra spent per order

₹72 middlemen-₹12 own packaging and returns= ₹60

Stakeholder Personas

	Churned from Meesho	Online Elsewhere	Offline Only
Who they are?	Have Meesho accounts and listings, but low activity due to low visibility	Already selling on other marketplaces, yet to onboard on Meesho	No online presence, still sell through the reseller pipeline
Main Ask	"Will anyone see my listings this time?"	"What's my net after fees and RTOs?"	"Will it sell? Who packs it?"
Pain Points	• No organic visibility without ratings, long wait until first order (avg 16 days) • Spent on ads and stock just to learn it doesn't sell • A worse-material copy took the "lowest price" tag • Got paid less than quoted, shipping and return charges showed up after dispatch	• Meesho's price bands sit below what an honest product costs to make and ship • Zero ratings on Meesho despite established ratings elsewhere • Higher RTOs on Meesho's COD-heavy Tier-2+ buyer base	• Per-order costs (shipping, fixed fee, return buffer, GST) not known when setting the price • Single-order packing and 2–3 day dispatch hassle • No prior experience in listing individual SKUs (photos, attributes, titles)
Goals & needs	• Get enough orders to justify relisting, and a clear idea of when to restock or stop • A way to identify an optimal ad spend budget • Competing on price and products, not on ratings	• Add volume without eroding Amazon price • Fees visible up front • A quick demand read	• Use idle capacity • Demand certainty before production • Someone else to handle parcels and returns • Inventory risk kept off the factory
Effort			

Manufacturer Segmentation

CATEGORY

Category Group	Spec Verifiability (30 %)	Savings post RTO costs (25%)	Middlemen Margin Capturable (25%)	Factories Reachable (20%)	Score /100
	Buyer test · 55%		Supply test · 45%		
Home & Kitchen	5	5	4	4	91
Fashion Accessories	4	4	5	4	85
Footwear	5	2	3	5	75
Beauty & Personal Care	3	5	4	3	75
Apparel	1	1	3	5	46
Electronics & branded FMCG	4	4	1	1	53

TYPE

	Owns Input?	Owns Machines?	Price Advantage Offered
Integrated Maker	✓	✓	High
Job Work Manufacturer	⊗	✓	Medium
Contract/ Assembler	⊗	!	Low
Trader/ MRP Brand	⊗	⊗	None

Why ownership, not scale

A ₹50 Cr trader moves more volume than a ₹8Cr integrated maker. But the trader removes ₹0 of the ₹72. The integrated maker removes all of it

TURNOVER BAND

For onboarding new manufacturers

BAND	CHARACTERISTICS
<₹5 CR	Thin cash, shallow stock, one person ops, low scale - high cost, quality not optimal
₹5 CR-25 CR	Owns machine, hold stock, can run a panel, still sell through middlemen, below the scale of Amazon/Flipkart programmes
>₹25 CR	Healthy B2B to protect, wooed by exclusive programmes, expect account managers

Bands screen for reliability, not price. Size doesn't predict a cost edge - it predicts ownership

The gap no competitor has filled yet

- **Below ₹ 5 Cr** – edge exists; supply breaks under volume
- **₹ 5- 25 Cr** – owns machine + input, idle capacity; no one has locked them in.
- **Above ₹ 25 Cr – Amazon & Flipkart** are already courting them

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Market Sizing & Opportunity

1. The Maker Base

4.72 Cr	All registered MSMEs · **Udyam**
4,91,064	Small enterprises upto ₹100 Cr · **Udyam**
~1,52,000	× 31% in manufacturing · **ratio**
~1,14,000	× ~75% inside ₹5-25 Cr · **TAM**
~66,000	× in our four launch categories · **est.**
~43,000	× integrated makers, not traders · **SAM**



SOM BUILDS THROUGH THE CALENDAR
Active Makers: 120→320→620
Each launch adds a lasting marker cohort.
Attrition: 300-600 →Online | 200-400 →Offline | 100-200 →Other

2. The Prize In Every Order

Buyer price	Middleman margin	To the buyer	Share of price
₹150	₹33	₹21	14%
₹265 AOV	₹72	₹60	23%
₹360	₹105	₹93	26%



Middleman margin is ~52% on top of ex-works, so the prize grows with price. Platform fees (₹55) stay roughly flat.

3. The Demand Pool · sized on orders

183.4 Cr **placed orders, FY25.** We size on orders because the saving is per order - which takes AOV out of the calculation.

CATEGORY MIX OF PLACED ORDERS · FY25 (RHP) · ORANGE = LAUNCH CATEGORIES



- Apparel **36.17%**
- Footwear and accessories **16.78%**
- Beauty & Personal Care **9.98%**
- Home, Kitchen and furnishing **17.24%**
- Kids and baby products **10.48%**
- Others **9.35%**

RHP combines footwear and accessories; we split ~60/40 toward accessories - our estimate.

4. Category Sequence from the Scorecard

1 Home & Kitchen	2 Fashion Accessories	3 Beauty & Personal Care	4 Footwear
+17.2%	+~10%	+10.0%	+~6.8%
17.2%	~27%	~37%	~44%

Bars = cumulative order share covered

Footwear last: its 22–35% return rate is the highest of the four, so it follows the lower-return categories

NOT SIZED: Kids & Baby, 10.48%, needs its own quality standard; a later candidate

EXCLUDED: Electronics & Branded FMCG - low score (53 vs 46); brand-owned margin, MRP-capped; most goods imported.

LATER: Apparel - 36% of orders; largest pool, but fails both buyer tests.



5. What Reaches The Buyer

Year one is time-weighted. Categories are added one at a time, so the fourth contributes nine months, not twelve

Category	Months	Share	Weighted
Home & Kitchen	12	17.2%	17.2%
Fashion Accessories	11	~10%	9.2%
Beauty & Personal Care	10	10.0%	8.3%
Footwear	9	~6.8%	5.1%
Effective exposure	~	**44%**	**~39.8%**

73 Cr orders of effective exposure in year one

Conversion →	10%	15%	20%
Year one · 73 Cr	₹438 Cr	₹657 Cr	₹876 Cr
Steady state · 81 Cr	₹484 Cr	₹726 Cr	₹969Cr
With apparel · 147 Cr	₹882 Cr	₹1,324 Cr	₹1,765 Cr

Conversion is a scenario band, not a forecast: the share of orders in these categories that move to factory-direct listings. Values are ₹60 saved per order, as on slide 1.

SAM · makers available ~43,000
Needed · with apparel ~6,100
Needed · year one ~3,050

STILL TO ESTABLISH: What share of listings are reseller-sourced? No public source gives it - we are sampling the top 50 listings per product type. The one input that moves the band

"Am I just moving my own orders?" No. A maker who sets ₹150 receives ₹150 everywhere - only the fee stack differs. Meesho's buyer is Tier 2-4, ₹265, 77% COD. A new order, not a moved one.

IMPACT ON MANUFACTURERS

₹50 lakh
additional annual revenue, on idle capacity

36,000 units (5% of a ₹10 Cr maker's ~7 lakh a year) × **₹138** ex-works = **₹49.7 lakh**

IMPACT ON CUSTOMERS

₹243
the most one buyer can save in a year

9.2 orders a year × **44%** in our categories × **₹60** saved = **₹240**

~620
new factory sellers in year one
7.8%
of the 43,000-maker SAM tapped at scale

IMPACT ON MEESHO

1.2 Cr
more orders a year + 0.7% on FY25's 183.4 Cr

80.7 Cr orders × **15%** factory-direct × **10%** new to Meesho = **1.2 Cr**

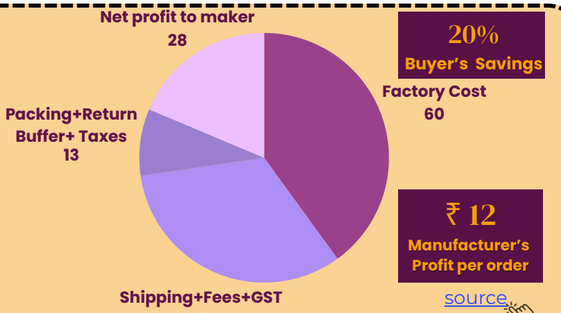
+0.7% on FY25's **183.4 Cr** orders

1 avoided RTO = 21 orders
(₹170 RTO cost ÷ ₹8.09 contribution per order)

Unit Economics for Target Category

Jewellery set:
Listing Price = ₹ 150

**Reseller Price for the Same Set:*
₹180-₹200



source

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Barrier-Lever Mapping

BARRIERS ACROSS THE USER JOURNEY

Acquisition barriers

ONBOARD DECISION → LISTING → LAUNCH

1 Decide



- **Demand:** No demand certainty before production
- **Awareness:** factories aren't looking; nobody tells them where their product is in demand.

2 Set up & stock



- **Product:** Listing individual SKUs is a hassle (photos, attributes, titles)
- **Price:** Per-order costs (shipping, fixed fee, return buffer, GST) not known when setting the price
- **Quantity:** Inventory risk transferred to the manufacturer

3 Go live



- **Catalog:** Factory photos and poor titles get fewer clicks than a reseller's polished listing, so the same boost brings fewer orders
- **Insight:** No simple read on views, clicks and price position — by the time the maker sees that it isn't selling, the boost has faded

Scaling barriers

RETENTION ← ORDER SETTLEMENT ← ORDER FULFILMENT

6 Stay or leave



- **Volume:** Too few early orders to justify continuing
- **Restock Signal:** No signal on whether to restock or stop

5 Close & settle orders



- **Returns:** Return logistics and damaged returns (unless claim succeeds) come off the maker's margin (~₹30–80 shipping/product)
- **Final Payout:** The payout is lower than the quote, charges surface after dispatch

4 Get & fulfill orders



- **Competition:** Price comparison ignores quality, so a worse copy can win the "lowest price" tag
- **Operations:** Single-parcel packaging and logistics, and dispatch in 24-48 hrs doesn't fit a bulk-shipping factory

Every strategy has boundaries. Before ranking any lever, we need to define **what success actually looks like** — and what automatically disqualifies a solution regardless of how attractive it appears.

Constraints

No subsidies

The price drop has to come from the factory's cost, not Meesho's discounts



No manual handholding

It can scale without a Meesho KAM per factory



Requirements

Price Competitiveness

The result must be a lower price for the buyers, not more sellers signed up



Durability

The lower price must stay & grow, not vanish when a seller raises price or runs out



Why Gates and Not Scores?

Scores average: Bad levers can hide behind strong scores elsewhere, even if they have some constraints or don't fulfill a requirement

Gates don't average: One "no" eliminates the lever before ranking.

Gates

G1 — Does it add per-order cost once built? (Subsidy Free)

Meesho keeps ~₹8 per order (DRHP FY25). Anything that spends per order eats the margin.

G2 — Does it work for hundreds of factories with no manpower assigned to each? (Scalable)

The PS rules out handholding that can't scale to hundreds.

G3 — Does it directly contribute to a reduced price for the buyer? (Price-reducing)

The goal is price competitiveness, not more sellers, improved operations or better dashboards.

G4 — Can sellers raise prices, run out, or swap materials after listing? (Durable)

The savings must last. Today the "Lowest price" tag rewards even a worse copy.

Acquisition Levers

Journey Step	Pain Point	Lever	Description
Decide	Demand	Demand insights	Gap sizing per product type, likely-share forecast, "what to make instead", the same data open to every seller
	Awareness	Targeted outreach	Exit lists, IndiaMART and cluster lists; win-back diagnosis for churned makers; WhatsApp only after opt-in
Set up & Stock	Product	AI listing bot	Product, quantity and price screens, with the health check built in
	Price	Price Integrity Layer	Cost check against B; fees shown before shipment
	Quantity	Demand-based lot commitment	First lot ≈ two weeks of expected orders, in units, made before listing; reserved in the committed-supply ledger
Go live	Catalog	SKU health coach	Reads the live listing's funnel; few clicks → fix the main image or title, with the shots top listings use
		Factory Launch Week	5 days of concentrated demand in a slot that doesn't depend on ratings, so a new catalogue earns orders & reviews
	Insight	SKU health coach	A weekly read of views, clicks and price position, with one fix in Hindi; a person steps in only if the fix fails

Scaling Levers

Journey Step	Pain Point	Lever	Description
Get & fulfill orders	Competition	Benchmark B and like-for-like	25th-percentile price buyers paid, same spec, per unit, quality floor; spec policing through returns and test buys
		Price band and auto price-hold	Break-even ≤ price ≤ B at listing, held as B moves; a breach removes the launch slot, then visibility
	Operations	Cluster Pack Point	One lot a week to a shared warehouse that packs, ships and takes returns; ₹30 per delivered order
Close & settle orders	Returns	RTO rate per SKU	Actual return and refusal rates in the cost stack and the coach; returns land at the Pack Point
	Final payout	AI listing bot	Fees shown at listing, locked at dispatch
Stay or leave	Volume	Factory Launch Week	Eligibility rule (manufacturer, records agree, price in band, stock ready), so early orders go to real makers
		Make to demand	Slow SKU stopped; "what to make instead" from the engine
	Restock signal	Reorder loop	Reorder point and next batch from the listing's run-rate; zero stock → out of ranked slots, page stays up

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Overall Solution

C2M PRICE CONTRIBUTION =

Makers onboarded × **Share active at day 30** × **Orders per maker** × **Price drop per order** × **Share retained at day 90**

① Factory Onboarding
fills the funnel

- Targeted outreach with a demand teaser
- Seller type + automatic GST/Udyam checks
- Cost check: two inputs, take-home at every price
- AI listing bot: product, quantity, price
- Cluster Pack Point: one lot a week, partner packs

≤ 14 days
contact → live listing

② Factory Launch Week
proves it in five days

- Eligibility by rule: maker, records, price in band, stock
- Published order book: slots, cap B, expected orders
- Demand-sized lots, in units, made before listing
- Launch section on home & deals; slots capped
- Launch ratings down-weighted; returns judge quality

≥ 0.5
stick rate at day 30

② Launch Week + ③ Growth Loop
keeps the orders coming

- Handover: boost continues, swaps unlock with the listing score
- Reorder loop: reorder point, next batch from run-rate
- Zero stock: out of ranked slots, page stays up
- SKU health coach: one cause, one fix, one nudge a week
- RTO rate per SKU in the cost stack

≥ 50%
makers on a 2nd lot in 45 days

Price Integrity Layer
makes the drop real

- Benchmark B: 25th-pct price buyers paid, same spec, per unit
- Like-for-like: identical specs only, quality floor
- Price band: break-even ≤ price ≤ B at listing
- Auto price-hold: gap to B kept as B moves
- Spec policing: returns and sampled test buys

≥ 8% of B
price drop per order

③ Growth Loop
makers switch products, not platforms

- Make to demand: stop what isn't selling
- Switch to what's missing: open-gap products for the same line
- Weekly Hindi nudge; one human step only after a failed fix
- Makers per manager rising: proof it scales
- Monthly launches rotate product types

≥ 60%
makers active at day 90

Demand Intelligence Engine fuels every term :

- Open demand-gap data for every seller
- Gap as a range with confidence
- Free in the pilot
- Manufacturers win on speed, not on access

Demand Teaser · **Order book & lot sizing** · **Restock Signal** · **B's comparables** · **Switch suggestions**

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Supporting Engines



Uday Singham, Kitchenware Manufacturer
"Kuch products bahut achha chalte hain, kuch bilkul nahi. Pehle se pata lagana mushkil hota hai ki kya chalega."

Proposed Solution

Demand Intelligence Engine

Read the searches, clicks, orders, stock-outs and returns data Meesho already logs, and convert it into actionable insights to be fed to the levers

Analyse the Data → Read the data, create metrics, and track changes in them

Diagnose the Metrics → Identify the gap & find the root cause that explains the metric change

Size the Gap → Open gap = Unserved Demand − Committed Supply; Expected Demand/SKU = Open Gap × Likely Share

Suggest Action → Turn the gap into an actionable opportunity for the manufacturers

• High search, • Low search-to-click • Few listings	**Supply gap** Buyers are searching but not finding what they want	Unserved Orders = Unserved Demand − Committed Supply	Acts as the demand teaser to makers and first-lot sizing
• High search • Many stock-outs	**Under-supplied** The product sells, but it's often sold out	Orders Lost = Stock-out Days × Daily run-rate	Restock sooner, or let new makers fill it
• High orders • Many product-reason returns	**Product gap** Buyers buy, then send it back for faults.	Returns above norm = Delivered orders × (Return rate − Category Median)	Fix the product, or make a better version
• High clicks & impressions • Low conversion (median price > maker's break-even)	**Price gap** Buyers look, but the price puts them off.	Orders a cheaper listing could win = Clicks × (Median Conversion − Current)	List lower, within cost

Metric to Track

Category Total Orders

Tells us whether filled gaps add demand or just shift orders between sellers

Category order after the gap was filled ÷ Category orders earlier

Access Rules

- Same market view for every seller, whether manufacturer, wholesaler or reseller
- SKU-level view only for that SKU's own seller

Risks & Guardrails

Risk	Early signal	Guardrail
Forecasts over-promise and makers lose faith	Actual orders/forecast orders < 60% by day 14	Quote the low end of every range; no pitch below Medium confidence; recalibrate weekly
Everyone chases the same gap	Committed supply/open gap ≥ 90%	Ledger counts new listings; "crowded" flag; small first lots
Fake commitments to scare off competitors	Rising expiry rate per selle	commitments capped at declared capacity; repeat expiries lose credibility



Janmejay Bhuyan, Jewellery Manufacturer
"Meesho pe same product ka lowest price kya hai, ye pata karna mushkil hota hai. Naye seller ko usse competitive price rakhna kaise samjhe?"

Proposed Solution

Price Integrity Layer

Makes sure every factory listing is genuinely cheaper than what buyers pay today for the same product, and stays that way

Benchmark B – the 25th percentile price buyer paid, per unit

- Same spec per unit
- Above the quality floor
- >N delivered orders
- Makers owns order excluded

Price band Break-even <= price<=B
- Onboarding: does a band exist?
- Listing: is the price inside it?

e.g. cost ₹148, B ₹160 - ₹148-160

→ **Like-for-Like Comparison**
- Same category, material, size, type
- Per unit, so packs compare fairly and a worse copy can't win

→ **Auto price-hold stay<= B as B moves**
- Costs up? B rises, so can the price.
- Tax cut? It must pass on.
- Breach: launch slot - visibility-review.

Gaming the price rule

Manufacturers may try to game their way around the price integrity rule, to earn higher profits

Gaming route	What catches it
Downgrading specs/using poor materials	"Not as described" returns above 1.5× the category norm
Raising the price after earning reviews	Auto price-hold
A rival dumping stock to drag B down	Percentile plus minimum orders; optional cap on any one seller's weight in B

Metric to Track

Price Drop Delivered

Tells us how much of the price drop actually reaches the buyer, order by order

$$\frac{\Sigma\,[\,(B - \text{Price}) \times \text{Orders}\,]}{\Sigma\,\text{Orders}}$$

Risks & Guardrails

Risk	Early signal	Guardrail
Sales drag B down	Sale-week B < 28-day B	Exclude event days
B set too loose	Price drop < target	Lower the percentile

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Factory Onboarding

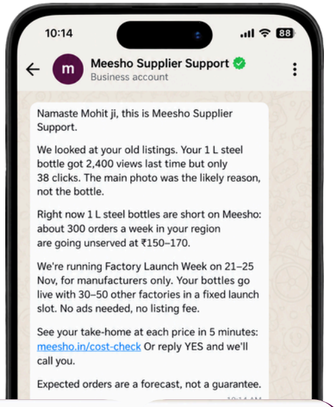


Samar Biswas, Footwear Manufacturer

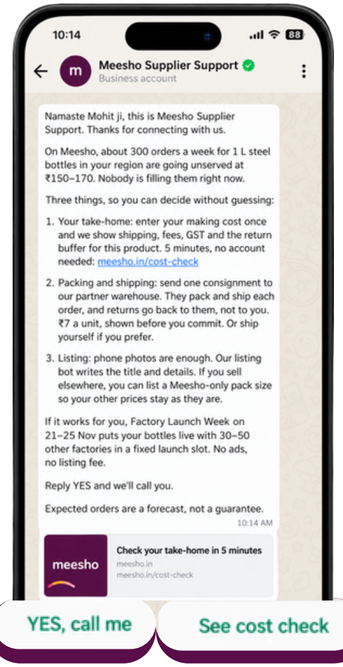
"Online try kiya tha, lekin orders consistently nahi aaye. Samajh nahi aaya ki Meesho pe actually kitna business mil sakta hai."

Targeted Manufacturer Outreach

Pitch to Churned Manufacturers



Pitch to Online elsewhere/Offline Manufacturers



Metrics to Track

1. **Conversion** — Target≥ 50%
   Tells us where makers drop out at each step, measured at each funnel step
2. **Time-to-live** — Target<14 days
   Measures the days from first contact to live listing, helps identify friction in the funnel

Risks & Guardrails

Risk	Early signal	Guardrail
Outreach breaks WhatsApp's opt-in rules	Block or report rate > 1%	First contact via IndiaMART inquiry or email; WhatsApp only after opt-in
Resellers pose as manufacturers	GST/Udyam mismatch > 10%	Not launch-eligible; the price band is hard for traders to hit
Makers drop off mid-funnel	Drop-off at any stage > 50%	Two inputs at the cost check; every bot field pre-filled; Hindi, WhatsApp-first

1 FIND

- Meesho's exit record.
- IndiaMart manufacturer profile
- Market place storefronts
- Cluster association list

2 PITCH

- Prototype demand teaser with a link to a 5-minute sign-up and cross check

3 SIGN UP & AUTO CHECKS

- Fill up the share type
- Confirm via GST, nature of buisness and Udyam academy types

4 COST CHECK

- Full cost stack check against benchmark B to test the eligiblity.

Prototype



Samar Biswas, Footwear Manufacturer

"Sir, hum log normally bulk mein maal bhejte hai. Online mein ek-ek parcel single bhejne mein bohot jhanjhat hai."

Cluster Pack Point

A shared micro-warehouse for manufacturers who don't want to deal with single-parcel logistics

MANUFACTURER → One bulk lot a week (like wholesale dispatch)

CLUSTER PACK POINT (Micro-warehouse)
~40 manufacturers | ~6,000 orders/month | ~1,200 sq ft | 4 staff
Inbound · Store · Pick & Pack · QC · Manifest

→ **VALMO** Sort · line haul last mile

→ **BUYER** Delivered

Returns come back to the warehouse, never the factory — weighed against dispatch, graded, restocked

Stage	What happens	Key details	Owner
Inbound	Lot received, counted, every unit weighed	Lot = 14 days of forecast demand	Partner
Storage	Racked, daily stock snapshot	Days 0–30 free ₹0.29/unit/day after D30	Partner (maker after 30d)
Pick · Pack · QC	Picked to order, photographed, weight vs. listing	Wrong item traces to the warehouse	Partner
Dispatch	Manifest + retry; one pickup for all makers	24h SLA	Partner
Returns	Opened, weighed vs. dispatch weight, graded A/B/C	Swapped item is provable	Partner

COST BREAKDOWN

Cost component	Reseller (₹)	C2M (₹)
Maker ex-works	138	**138**
Three middlemen	+72	**Removed**
Meesho fees + return provision	+55	**+55**
Warehouse fee	—	**+30**
Buyer pays	**₹265**	**₹223**

Saving ₹42 (16%)
Grossed for RTO — the pack point packs orders that never deliver, and someone pays for that work.

DENSITY GATE

Fee per delivered order, by makers pooled

20	40	60	80
₹44	₹30	₹26	₹23

Below 40 makers, the warehouse does not pay.

WHY MEESHO WANTS IT

- **Asset-light:** partner owns building and staff
- SOP, routing, forecast handled by partner
- **Missing node:** Valmo has first mile and last mile — no fulfilment
- **Bulk dispatch**: 40 first-mile pickups become one

WHAT IS NEW

- Meesho No-Pack packs centrally — only for high-return SKUs, with no storage at maker end
- Ours adds storage (0–30 days free), returns at the node, and listing weight as fraud check
- Makers stay focused on production

WHERE IT CAN FAIL

- **Slow stock:** a unit sitting 60 days costs ₹17.50 in rent, so lots cover 14 days and makers pay storage from day 31.
- **Too few makers:** Below 40, the fee climbs past ₹30, so a warehouse opens only at 40 makers; self-ship stays available.
- **Unproven fee:** ₹30 comes from our model (Shiprocket charges ₹24); we need a pooled 3PL quote before Launch 2.

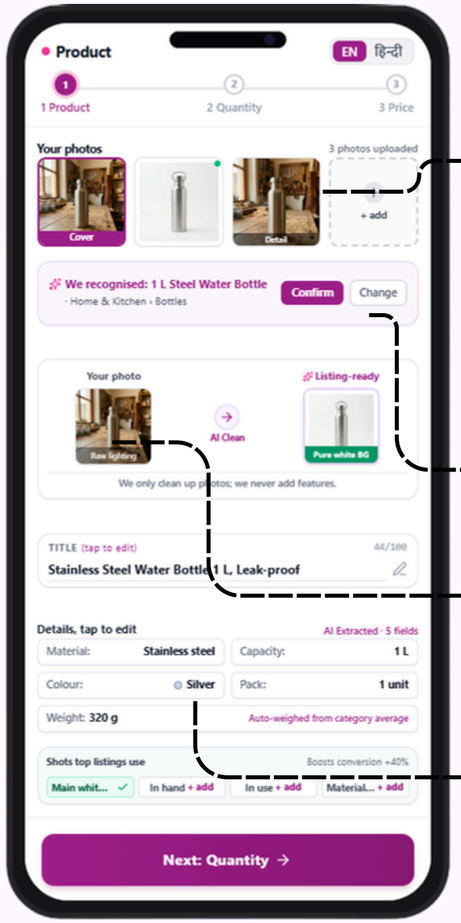
Factory Onboarding-AI Listing Bot



Jasmeet Sharma, Kitchenware Manufacturer

"Listing banana kaafi time le leta hai. Photos, details, size — sab kuch manually karna padta hai."

Upload three to five phone photos and the bot recognises the product, cleans the images to a white background, and writes the title from what buyers search for. Attributes come pre-filled for the maker to edit, and a shot list shows which photos top listings use.



Seller uploads phone photos

Bot identifies the product type

Bot provides Clean images

Bot auto-fills product attributes, can be edited by the seller

Screen 1: Product Listing Page

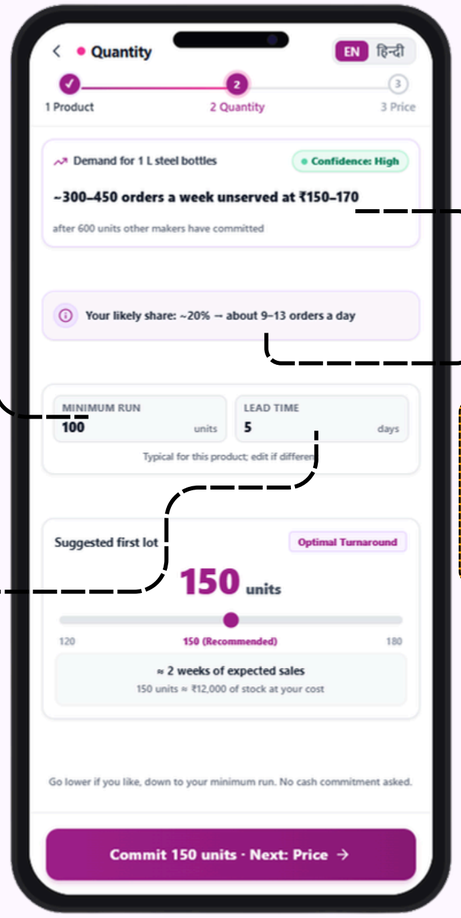
Product type feeds the demand for the product type



Jasmeet Sharma, Kitchenware Manufacturer

"Kitna maal banana hai, woh hum usually apne experience se decide karte hain. Kabhi zyada ban jaata hai, kabhi demand miss ho jaati hai."

Description: Shows real demand for the maker's product type: unserved orders a week, how sure we are, and what others have already committed. Minimum run and lead time come pre-filled. The bot suggests a first lot of about two weeks of expected sales, in units, and the maker can only go lower.



Seller enters minimum run

Seller enters lead time

Bot suggests a first lot of about two weeks of expected sales

Lot size feeds the per unit costbuffer

[Prototype]

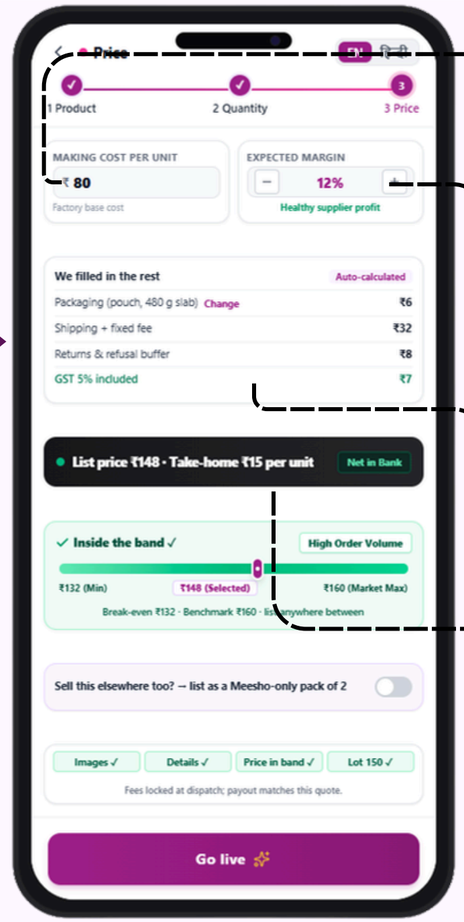
Screen 2: Lot Sizing Page



Saksham Sinha, Manufacturer

"Price toh cost dekh ke rakhte hain, lekin market mein kitne mein chalega woh pehle se pata nahi hota."

Description: The maker enters only making cost and the margin they want. The bot fills in packaging, shipping, fees, GST and a returns buffer from real data for that product type, then shows the list price and take-home, checks it against the benchmark, and runs the go-live checklist. Fees shown here are locked at dispatch.



Seller enters making cost

Seller enters expected margin

Bot makes the full cost stack

Bot shows the list price and take home, checks it against B

Screen 3: Price Setting Page

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Factory Launch Week



Jasmeet Sharma, Kitchenware Manufacturer

"Shuru mein rating nahi hoti, reviews nahi hote, toh orders hi nahi aate. Visibility kaise banegi?"

Proposed Solution

Factory Launch Week





Instead of onboarding factories one at a time into an empty search page, where they compete with rated resellers, we onboard them together and market the day: a **5-day Factory Launch Week**

Supporting levers

Demand-based lot commitment
- Manufacturers only allot a small inventory
- First lot ≈ two weeks of expected orders sized by the Demand Intelligence Engine

Cluster Pack Point
One consignment to a 3PL that stores, packs and ships; returns land there; published fee; self-ship optional

Guardrail Levers

- **Price band:** Break-even ≤ **price** ≤ B, where B is determined by the Price Integrity Layer
- **Auto-price hold:** Keep the gap to B as B moves; a breach removes the launch slot, then visibility



BENEFITS



	During launch	Post-launch
Manufacturer	• Concentrated Demand on day one seen directly, not competing with rated resellers	• Reviews earned in days, not months • Best-priced in their segment
Buyer	• Lower price on the same products	• The lower price stays
Meesho	• Price reduction without discounts or subsidies • More traffic, more supply, more demand	• A cohort of manufacturers with proven demand ready for reorded loop

Prototype

30-day Launch Timeline

WEEK 1 — Set up and commit
Get the foundation right

- Fix the launch dates; publish the order book (slots, price caps, last sale's avg orders, warehouse fee)
- Sign up 30-50 manufacturers- each picks its SKUs & commits demand-sized lots

WEEK 2 — Stock and listing
Bring products to Meesho

- Production runs. The AI listing bot builds catalogues from phone photos
- Promote the campaign to gather traction

WEEK 3 — Dry run and launch
Execute and monitor

- Go through every listing - lock prices, link the stock
- Launch runs days 21–25: every day, compare orders against the matched deals

WEEK 4 — Read and decide
Measure impact and plan

- Deliveries arrive, returns close, early reviews come in - compare with the controls
- Decide reorders on post-launch order-rate
- The day-30 invest / tighten / stop rule is applied

01 02 03 04

What happens after 5 days of launch?
- Monthly Launch Weeks, rotating product types within the two pilot categories, then the next categories on the scorecard (beauty & personal care, footwear)
- **Launch Week 1:** Online Elsewhere and Churned from Meesho Manufacturers
  Launch Week 2 onwards: Offline only makers, once Partner Warehousing is setup

Metric to Measure

Lasting demand for sellers

Stick Rate

Tells whether Launch Week created a lasting visibility for a new seller

Orders per launched SKU in D26-30 ÷ Median orders of an existing SKU in the category

Target≥ 0.5

Measured per day across the same product type

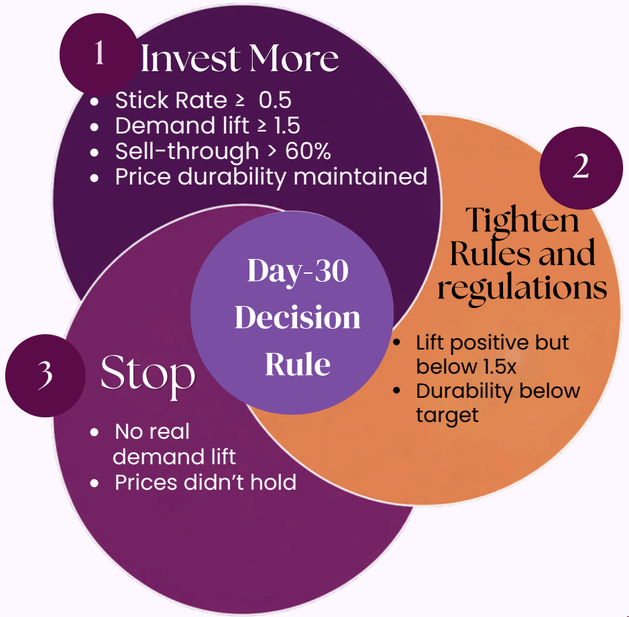
Post Launch Visibility

After the week: nothing new is built for ranking.
- The onboarding boost continues for **3–6 months**.
- Launch orders and reviews build a **listing-level quality score** that replaces the inherited seller-level one.
- Once that score matches a pricier equivalent's, Meesho's own cheaper-equivalent swap puts the listing in that slot.

Risks & Guardrails

Risk	Early signal	Guardrails
Orders collapse after the week	Days 26–30 order rate vs launch week	• Onboarding boost continues • SKU coach flags the cause • Reorders sized to the post-launch order rate
A maker games the launch (low price in, higher price after)	Price breaches in days 26–30	Auto price-hold; launch placement and visibility removed on breach

The Day-30 Decision Rule

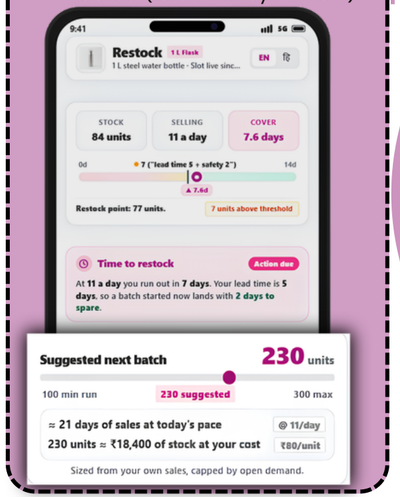


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Make-to-Demand Growth Loop

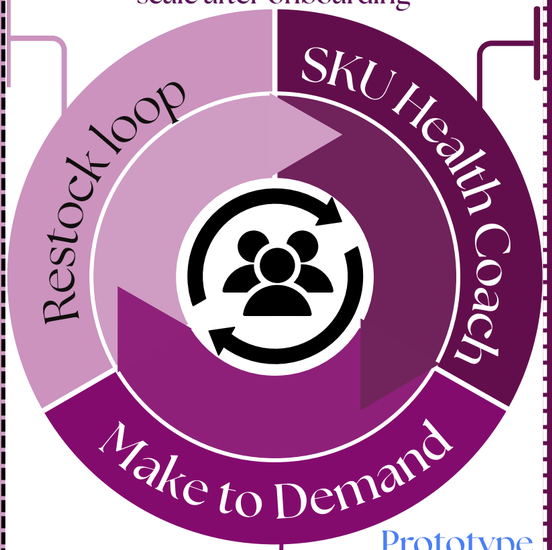
Uses the Demand Engine to make the restock decision

- Run-rate from the listing's last 7 days, trend-adjusted
- Reorder point = run-rate × (lead time + safety days)
- Next batch ≈ 21 days of sales, never below the minimum run, dated ("start 150 by 24 Nov")



90-day Retention Loop

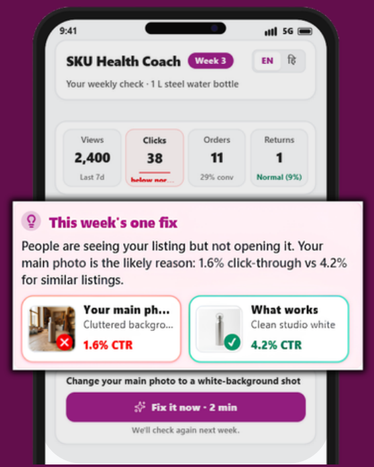
To ensure manufacturers stay & scale after onboarding



Prototype

Tracks listings & analyses metrics

- Few clicks → change image or title
- Clicks but no buy → Improve price
- Returns up → product fix
- One fix, one Hindi nudge, one tap to act

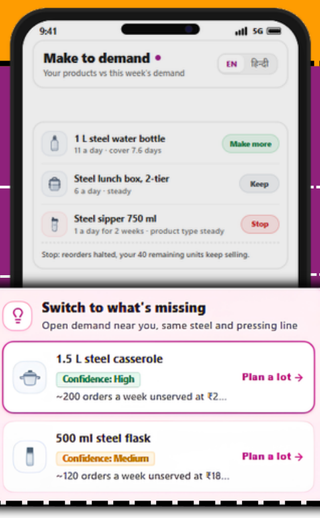


The SKU Health Coach

Trigger	Condition	Action
Weak listing	• Impressions normal • Click-through below the 25th percentile	Fix the main image or title
Price problem	• Clicks fine • Conversion below the 25th percentile • Price above the matched median	Price check showing take-home at each price point
Trust or spec problem	• Clicks fine • Conversion low • Price competitive	Add a scale photo, a material close-up
Product Fix	Returns above the 75th percentile, mostly product reasons	Grouped return reasons sent as a production change
Listing Fix	Returns above the 75th percentile, mostly expectation reasons	Fix photos and description that over-promise
Stop or switch	• Sell-through below the 25th percentile • 2+ weeks while the product type is steady	Stop, with "what to make instead"

Demand Requirement

Demand Requirement	Resellers	Manufacturers
Increase Supply	Need 2-3 weeks: Find a supplier, wait on their MOQ and transport	Need just 3-5 days: Can run a batch on their own line
Fix Product	Can't; it's someone else's product	Can directly change the spec in the next batch
Change Product	Source a new product from scratch, new supplier, new terms	Already have the material and the machines, can directly produce it in-house
Pricing product at B	A middleman's margin comes first, so B often sits below cost	Reach B from factory cost with margin to spare



Metrics to Track

1. **Makers active by D90** — Target ≥ 60%
   Whether retention works
   Active makers ÷ makers launched
2. **Second-lot rate** — Target ≥ 50%
   Whether the channel is meaningful to them
   Makers on a 2nd lot by day 45 ÷ makers launched
3. **Fix success** — Target ≥ 40%
   Whether the diagnoses are right
   metric back in band within 14 days of a coach action
4. **Fix success** — Target ≥ 40%
   Whether makers act on the nudges
   Coach actions taken ÷ actions sent

When do we need a Meesho KAM?



- **Only when:** A fix has been applied twice or more and the listing still isn't selling, meaning our diagnosis was wrong.
- **What they do:** Find the real cause, and turn it into a new rule so the coach catches it next time.
- **Proof it scales:** Manufacturers per manager, measured in the pilot, should rise with every launch.

Risks & Guardrails

Risk	Early signal	Guardrail
Nudges ignored	Actions taken < 40%	One action a week, one tap, in Hindi; escalation only after two ignored nudges
Wrong diagnosis	Fix success below 50%	Minimum data before a trigger fires; weekly recalibration

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30 - 60 - 90 Day Roadmap

From Launch to Habit: a 90-day roadmap that pilots Factory Launch Week, the Cluster Pack Point and the Growth Loop, gated at days 30, 60 and 90 before anything scales

	Sprint A Weeks 0–2	Sprint B Weeks 3–4	Sprint C Weeks 5–6	Sprint D Weeks 7–8	Sprint E Weeks 9–10	Sprint F Weeks 11–12
Focus	Set up: demand data live, order book out, 30–50 makers committed	Launch Week 1: Home & Kitchen, days 21–25, against control districts	Open up: engine for all categories; reorder loop and coach live	Launch Week 2: Fashion Accessories + offline makers via the Pack Point	Make to demand live; second cluster and Beauty order book scoped	Launch Week 3, day-90 scorecard, scale or stop
Ships	Demand engine for Home & Kitchen, open to every seller	Lots made and listed; every listing in band, stock linked	Demand data opened for all categories	Cluster Pack Point live at the 40-maker floor	Make to demand: stop / switch per SKU	Launch Week 3: Beauty & Personal Care
	Benchmark B, cost check and the AI listing bot	Launch section live in Promotions and the buyer app	Reorder loop + SKU health coach, weekly	One bulk lot a week per offline maker; returns at the node	Moradabad node scoped on the Rajkot P&L	Day-90 scorecard across all three launches
	Order book published: slots, price cap, expected orders, fee	Launch ratings down-weighted; returns judge quality	RTO rate per SKU in the cost stack	Launch Week 2 with a published order book	Monthly launch calendar fixed	Footwear go / no-go on ~10 weeks of H&K returns
Implementation	1 Exit lists, IndiaMART, cluster lists; WhatsApp only after opt-in 2 Contract the Rajkot Pack Point and dry-run it; live before Launch 2 3 Pick control districts that will not see the launch	1 Daily coach during the launch and boost window 2 Sold-out listings leave ranked slots until restocked 3 Day-30 data: stick rate, lift, sell-through, prices, NAD	1 Reorders sized on the days 26–30 run-rate, dated 2 Fashion Accessories order book published; offline makers recruited 3 Storage: days 0–30 free, ₹0.29/unit/day after	1 Fee per delivered order tracked against the ₹30 model 2 RTO on node orders vs a self-pack control 3 Returns weighed against dispatch, graded A/B/C	1 Slow SKUs stopped; switch suggestions from open gaps 2 Day-60 storage decisions on slow stock 3 Beauty order book only once verification covers formulation	1 Price drop delivered measured across launches 2 Refusals vs the 17.8% blended baseline 3 Scale plan: 40–85 makers a month → ~1,020 by Q4
KPIs	**≥ 30** makers committed by day 7 **≥ 90%** stock ready by day 18	**≥ 1.5×** demand lift vs control **≥ 0.5** stick rate at day 30	**≥ 60%** forecast attainment **≥ 50%** on a 2nd lot by day 45	**≤ ₹30** fee per delivered order at 40+ makers **≥ 1.0** stick rate, cohort 1	**≤ 45 d** dwell before stop / switch **rising** makers per manager	**≥ 60%** makers active at day 90 **≥ 8% of B** price drop delivered
Gate & confidence	Owner: launch team + engine — high	GATE 1 · DAY 30: Invest / tighten / stop — high	Owner: engine + growth loop — med	GATE 2 · DAY 60: Pack Point pays or waits — med	Owner: growth loop + partner — high	GATE 3 · DAY 90: scale or fix — high

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THANK YOU



Team RK

IIT KHARAGPUR

ATIN PATNI
VINAYAK VIRMANI
VINAY RAUT

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APPENDIX



Primary Research

Questions we asked manufacturers

#	Topic	What we wanted to learn	How we asked it (Hinglish)
0	Who are you	Do they make it or trade it; size; channels	"Aap kya banate hain, aur kitna kaam apni factory mein hota hai, raw material se finished product
1	Demand	How they decide what to make; would they trust	"Agar Meesho dikhaye: ye product hafte mein ~400 bikta hai ₹150–170 mein, aur supply kam hai, toh kya
2	Paying for data	Would they pay for demand data, and how	"Jo order isse aaye uspe chhoti fees, ya mahine ka fixed? Kyun?"
3	Crowding	Would knowing others are making it change their	"Kya ye jaanna kaam aayega ki 3 factories pehle se ~600 piece bana rahi hain?"
4	Listing	Who lists today; time per product; trust in an AI	"Agar aap phone se photo kheenchein aur app khud listing bana de, use karenge?"
5	Pricing	Do they know their take-home after fees	"Shipping, fixed fee, GST, returns ke baad haath mein kitna aata hai, pata hota hai?"
6	Batch size	Smallest batch that still makes money; lead time	"Sabse chhota batch kitna hai jo aap fayde mein bana sakte hain?"
7	Packing and shipping	Would they send stock to a shared warehouse; fee they would accept	"Agar aap ek baar bulk maal ek warehouse bhej dein, aur wo pack, ship aur returns sambhaale, toh karenge? Per piece kitni fees theek lagti hai?"
8	Stock risk	What happens to a batch that doesn't sell	"Agar batch nahi bika, toh uska kya hota hai?"
9	Other channels	Does selling cheaper here upset other buyers	"Agar Meesho pe sasta bechein, toh Amazon pe ya distributor ke saath problem hogi?"
10	Staying on	How many orders make online worth it	"Mahine mein kitne order aayein toh online aapke liye worth hai?"
11	Sale events	Do they plan for festive sales	"Tyohaar ya badi sale ke liye alag taiyaari karte hain?"
12	Trust	What would make them refuse outright	"Ek cheez jo hone pe aap bilkul try nahi karenge, chahe kuch bhi offer ho?"

A garment maker selling on Meesho, Flipkart and Myntra

Topic	What he said	What we took from it
Packing today	"We pack every order ourselves. The bag is about ₹3.50 with manpower, call it ₹4 to ₹5 a piece with	Packing costs a maker about ₹4–5 an order; our cost check uses this
Lots on other sites	"Flipkart and Myntra take lots. If a product sells, 1,000 to 1,500 pieces a month. A lot can go in a	Makers already know the send-one-lot model; the Pack Point isn't
Unsold returns	"On Flipkart, Flipkart bears it. On Myntra, we do."	Who pays for returned stock is their first question; we must
Lots on Meesho?	"No, not for Meesho. Their warehouse system is informal. Flipkart and Myntra have a whole team;	A warehouse with no clear owner for each step will be refused
Lots and visibility	"If you take the lot option, you get more visibility."	Linking fulfilment to placement is already normal
Returns on Meesho	"Meesho sells more for us than Flipkart and Amazon, but has the most fraud, the most	Returns hurt margins more than fees do; checking weight at
Return pickup	"The pickup boy doesn't check the product. Sometimes something filthy comes back	Same: weigh it out, weigh it back
Paying for data	"No. The data won't be of use to me. It gives an analysis I can do myself, for free."	Demand data must be free; its value is what it unlocks
Prices across sites	"Same product, ₹100 cheaper on Meesho than on Myntra. The settlement differs."	Makers already price per site; we compare only within Meesho
Would packing help?	"They can't guarantee sales growth. But if a product goes viral and the warehouse handles	Fulfilment matters when demand spikes, so the Pack Point starts

All call transcripts

Primary research · what Mentor told us

Meesho's point	How the solution answers it
Order forecasting and storage cost: stock that sits breaks any node	Lots sized to 14 days of demand; storage free to day 30, charged from day 31, forced decision at day 60
Profitable for every party, not only Meesho	Pack Point P&L shows the partner's profit line; the maker's lot P&L shows the same per-unit realisation as wholesale
QC ownership: who manages wrong item, wrong variant	Pre-dispatch QC at the pack point with photo and weight; the node is the last party to touch the parcel
Returns should not travel back to the factory	Returns land at the node, weighed against dispatch, graded A/B/C, restocked
End-to-end attribution: seller, courier or facility fraud must be separable	One weight captured at listing makes the three cases provable (fault-attribution table, Pack Point slide)
Courier serviceability varies by pincode	The pack point is a pickup address; Meesho's allocation engine still picks the courier per pincode
Manifestation retries: who retries when a pickup fails	The pack point owns manifestation on a 24-hour SLA, 48-hour escalation

Also from the call

- New listings get a visibility boost that tapers over 3–6 months
- A cheaper equivalent can take a pricier listing's ranked slot if its quality score (share of 1–2 star ratings) is as good
- Orders must dispatch within 24–48 hours or auto-cancel; sellers aren't charged for refusals if they dispatch on time
- Vaimo does pickup and delivery, not storage
- Demand data must be open to every seller; no volume can be guaranteed to a maker
- Permanent sale framing erodes buyer trust

Segment research

Category data

Category	Retail size	Online penetration	Unbranded share	Online return rate	Maker base
Apparel	USD 88 bn (2025, IMARC)	~19% of fashion (Redseer)	Mass segment 71.6%	18–32% (women's ethnic, seller guides)	~95 lakh unincorporated units; Tiruppur ~28k, Metiabruz ~18k
Footwear	USD 20.7 bn (IMARC)	inside fashion's ~19%	65–70% unorganised	22–35%	Agra ~5k cottage + ~250 mechanised
Home & kitchen	₹57,100 Cr FY25; stainless steel ₹22,700 Cr	~5% (Redseer "others"); ~25% for SS kitchenware	Rajkot the primary low-end producer; BIS/ISI mandate favours	6–9%	Moradabad ~9k units; Rajkot; Jagadhri
Fashion jewellery	USD 4.98 bn (≈₹42k Cr)	30–35% via D2C and marketplaces	Mostly small businesses (IBEF); designs copied in 3–6 weeks	18–22%	Mumbai, Jaipur, Rajkot, Surat
Beauty & personal care	not sized	~19%	Branded; excluded from the fragmented set	low	Contract makers (Baddi, Hisar)
Home decor	~₹170 bn FY25	~5%	Regional and unbranded serve niche demand	n/a	Craft clusters

The structural fact, in Meesho's own filing. Regional brands and unbranded products are more than 75% of Indian retail, projected to hold 70–74% by FY30, yet only 25–30% of e-commerce GMV in FY25. Between them sit 80,000–100,000 distributors, 3–5 million wholesalers and 15–20 million retailers.

What the table says on its own. The two largest unbranded pools are apparel and kitchenware; kitchenware is at ~5% online with 6–9% returns and a BIS mandate, apparel at ~19% online with 18–32% returns. Jewellery has the highest online share among fragmented categories and the highest copy risk. BPC and electronics are not fragmented by Redseer's definition. Room is largest where fragmentation is high and returns are low. Meesho today (RHP): fashion 21–23%, home, kitchen & furnishing 23–25%, BPC 8–10% of e-commerce category GMV.

Market sizing Derivations

Number on the slide	How it was derived	Status
₹72 middleman margin removed	Indian distribution norms on a ₹265 order: distributor 5–8%, wholesaler 10–15%, reseller 20–30%; the stack shown on slide 1 (distributor ₹9, wholesaler ₹18, reseller ₹45)	Sourced
₹55 Meesho fees + return provision	Filing: ₹51.17 average charged to the seller FY25, plus GST on fees; ₹43.1 is the directly attributable cost, so Meesho keeps ~₹8	Sourced
₹138 maker ex-works	₹265 − ₹72 − ₹55; equals the price the maker already gets from wholesale	Derived
₹120 maker cost to produce	No public source for the internal split; affects the maker's sheet only, not the buyer price	Estimate
17.8% blended RTO	COD 76.95% of shipped × (1 − 77.70% COD success) + prepaid 23.05% × (1 − 97.28% prepaid success)	Sourced, filing
₹30 pack fee per delivered order	₹24.9 fee per order handled (bottom-up build, cross-checked against Shiprocket's published ₹24) ÷ (1 − 17.8%)	Derived
₹42 saving (16%)	₹72 removed − ₹30 fulfilment; the pack point applies above ₹175, below which the fee eats the margin removed	Derived
~39.8% effective exposure, ~73 Cr orders	Σ (category share × months live ÷ 12): H&K 17.2% × 12/12 + accessories ~10% × 11/12 + BPC 10.0% × 10/12 + footwear ~6.8% × 9/12, on 183.4 Cr placed orders	Derived
₹460 Cr buyer saving (base)	73 Cr orders × 15% conversion × ₹42; ₹307 Cr at 10%, ₹613 Cr at 20%; ₹927 Cr once apparel adds 74 Cr orders	Scenario band
~3,050 makers needed at 15%	Converted orders ÷ orders a maker can serve a year (150-unit lots, roughly one a month, ~1,800 units); ~6,100 with apparel	Derived
₹374 Cr reverse logistics avoided	11.0 Cr converted orders × 2 pp RTO reduction × ₹170 (₹50 forward already spent + ₹120 reverse); one avoided RTO ≈ 21 orders at ₹8.09 contribution	Estimate: the 2 pp is ours
₹8–10 lakh per maker a year	6,000 units × ₹138 ex-works; ~1% of a ₹10 Cr maker's output at the same unit price as wholesale	Derived

Demand Engine Input Data

Input (all already logged by Meesho)	Used for
Searches mapped to product types	Search demand
Impressions, clicks, orders, delivered orders	The conversion funnel
Listing attributes and title text	Grouping listings into product types
Prices buyers actually paid	Price bands; benchmark B
Returns, with reasons	Product gaps; quality
Refusals on COD orders	Refusal risk in the cost stack
Stock status of live listings	Stock-outs and lost orders
Makers' declared lots	The committed-supply ledger

Calculating a manufacturer's likely share:
To estimate a new listing's share, we looked at every listing launched in the same product type over the last 6–12 months. For each one, we divided its orders in the first 28 days by the open gap that existed when it went live. The middle value is our base share; the 25th–75th percentile spread gives us the range. Listings priced below the median tend to capture more, so we adjust for price, and we adjust again for how many sellers are going after the same gap. Each week we check actual orders against the forecast and recalibrate. If a product type doesn't have enough history, we split the gap evenly among the sellers we expect to enter, flag the forecast as low confidence, and only suggest the minimum batch.

Confidence.

- High = at least 4 stable weeks with high volume
- Low = minimum run only, no outreach teaser.

Every gap is a range, and the teaser always quotes the low end

Data access rules for sellers

Rule	What it says
Open to every seller	The same market view for manufacturers, wholesalers and resellers; phased by category, never by seller; makers win on speed, not access
Private SKU view	A listing's own funnel is visible only to its seller
Aggregation	District level with minimum volumes, so no buyer can be identified and no single competitor's sales inferred
No fake-door listings	Demand is read from searches, clicks and stock-outs, never from "coming soon" listings that pull buyers off live inventory
Free in the pilot	Benefits (lot range, ledger reservation, pre-filled listing, launch eligibility) come through "create listing from this insight"; any later fee is per order, never for viewing

Estimating B for a 1L steel bottle

Listing (1 L steel bottle)	Price	Delivered orders	Quality score	Counted?
A	₹99	400	Below floor	No: poorly rated
B	₹135	6	OK	No: too few orders
C (the maker's own)	₹155	120	OK	No: own orders excluded
D	₹150	250	OK	Yes
E	₹160	300	OK	Yes
F–J	₹165–₹190	450	OK	Yes
B	**₹160**	**250 of 1,000 qualifying orders sit at or below**		25th percentile

Measuring the price drop delivered

Price drop delivered = Σ (B - price) × orders ÷ total orders.

Makers at ₹145 (3,000 orders), ₹150 (1,500) and ₹158 (2,000) against B ₹160 → ₹64,000 over 6,500 orders ≈ ₹9.85 an order.

Every manufacturer order counts; above-B orders count as negative savings, so a maker selling above B pulls the number down.

Design choices behind Benchmark B

Design choice	Why
Delivered prices, not listed prices	A listing nobody buys cannot game it
Net of platform-funded coupons	B reflects the seller's price, not a discount Meesho paid for
25th percentile, not the cheapest	One clearance item or junk listing cannot set an impossible bar
Per unit	Pack sizes compare fairly; a shrunk pack shows as a price rise
Quality floor via Meesho's score	Cheap junk cannot define "cheap"; matches the swap's own gate
28 days, sale days excluded	Mega-sale prices would drag B down temporarily

Cost Check Fields

Input	Who provides it at the cost check	Refined later, where
Product type	Maker picks from a search ("1 L steel bottle")	Bot product screen, from the actual listing
Making cost per unit	Maker types it; the ex-factory price to distributors also works (conservative, since it already holds their B2B margin)	—
Setup cost, lot size	Default: zero, or typical for the type	Bot quantity screen spreads setup over the chosen lot
Packaging, weight, shipping slab	Default: the product type's typical packed weight (Meesho holds shipping weight for every listing)	Bot price screen, one question ("packed weight? pre-filled 480 g")
Fulfilment	Default: the Pack Point fee card, with a self-ship toggle	Bot price screen, the maker's choice
Return and refusal rates	Meesho's data for the product type, not the maker's	—
Fixed fee, shipping by slab and zone, GST on fees	Meesho's fee card; zone mix from the product type's order history	—
Output GST	From the product type's HSN code (kitchenware 5% since 22 Sep 2025)	—
TCS/TDS	Statutory rates	—
Benchmark B	Computed per product type	—

Rules for AI Listing Bot

- No field without a default
- No field asked before it is used.
- Minimum run and lead time appear on the quantity screen, pre-filled with the type's typical values.
- Capacity is asked only if a maker tries to commit more than the standard first-lot cap.
- Material and process are inferred from the product type.
- "Sell elsewhere?" is a yes/no on the price screen.
- Nothing about money is asked at sign-up; the first lot is chosen in units from a range the maker can only lower.

Appendix - Cluster Pack Point

Cost Breakdown (for different maker pool sizes)

Makers pooled	20	40 (base)	60	80
Orders a month	3,000	6,000	9,000	12,000
Area (sq ft)	833	1,167	1,500	1,833
Staff: packers + handlers + supervisor	1 + 1 + 1	2 + 1 + 1	2 + 2 + 1	3 + 2 + 1
Monthly cost	₹92,444	₹1,26,444	₹1,60,444	₹1,94,444
Cost per order handled	₹30.8	₹21.1	₹17.8	₹16.2
Fee per order handled (cost × 1.18)	₹36.4	**₹24.9**	₹21.0	₹19.1
Partner profit a month	₹16,640	₹22,760	₹28,880	₹35,000
Fee per delivered order (÷ (1 − 17.8% RTO))	**₹44**	**₹30**	**₹26**	**₹23**

Caveats

- Below 40 makers the fee per delivered order exceeds what the maker saves; 40 is the density floor. 60–80 is comfortable.
- Rent per unit-day ₹0.29 at 40 makers; a unit that sits 60 days costs ₹17.50.
- Free till day 30 (matches the published card), charged to the maker from day 31, forced decision at day 60.

Assumptions.

- 150 orders per maker a month (one 150-unit lot)
- 26 working days
- 50 units on hand per maker
- 3 units per sq ft
- 500 sq ft fixed ops area
- Rent ₹15/sq ft (Tier-2 shed, ₹12–18 band)
- Salaries: Packer ₹14,000, handler ₹14,000, supervisor ₹22,000 a month
- 180 orders per packer a day
- Consumables ₹5 an order
- ₹2.5 lakh equipment over 36 months
- ₹8,000 utilities · partner margin 18% (3PL norm 15–20%).

The cross-check. Our ₹24.9 at 40 makers reproduces Shiprocket Fulfillment's published ₹24 for 500–3,000 orders a month.

What could break the model

Sensitivity: what breaks it	Base	Breaks at
Makers pooled per node	40	below ~35
Average storage dwell	10–14 days	above ~45 days
Pack fee per order handled	~₹25	above ~₹35
Blended RTO rate	17.80%	above ~25%
RTO reduction from pre-dispatch	2.0 pp (our	below ~0.5 pp

Appendix - Cluster Pack Point

Per OrderEarnings per Stakeholder

Party	Receives	Of which cost	Keeps
Maker	₹138	₹122	₹16: same realisation as B2B; the gain is volume on idle capacity
Pack Point partner	₹24.9	₹21.1	₹3.8
Meesho	₹55	₹43.1	₹11.9 (filing: ₹51.17 charged, ₹43.1 attributable cost)
Carriers (Valmo + 3PL)	₹43.1	₹43.1	pass-through, ~4.5 handovers per order

Cost ownership in different conditions

Symptom	Weight at scan-out	Weight at return	Verdict, who pays
Buyer says wrong item	differs from listing	—	Pack point picked wrong
Buyer says empty or swapped	matches listing	differs from dispatch	Buyer swapped it; claim denied
Parcel never arrived	matches listing	no scan-in	Carrier loss; carrier
Damaged	matches	matches, damaged	Transit damage; carrier
Genuinely not as described	matches	matches	Maker mis-declared; maker

Manufacturer's Earning Meesho vs Wholesale

- Selling a 150-unit batch wholesale earns ₹2,700 in cash this round.
- On Meesho at 60% sold, the maker earns ₹931 in cash and keeps 82 units (worth ₹11,264) to sell next round.
- About a quarter of units come back unsold or returned, so the gain is extra volume on spare capacity, not more per piece.

Existing 3PL Providers Meesho could partner with

3PL that could run a node	Reach	Takes bulk · packs to spec · handles returns
WareIQ	13+ cities, 27,000+ pincodes; direct Meesho integration	✓ · ✓ · ✓
Eshopbox	5 cities; via Unicommerce	✓ · ✓ · ✓
Prozo	50+ FCs, 15–20 cities; ProOMS	✓ · ✓ · ✓
Shiprocket Fulfillment	42+ FCs; published rate card ₹24	✓ · ✓ · to be confirmed
Delhivery / Stockarea	Carrier for small sellers / broker model	Not a fit for v1

Order Book fields

Order-book field	Where it comes from	Rule
Slots open per product type	Open gap ÷ expected orders per launch listing (e.g. 300–450 a	Capped, so launch listings cannot swamp a category; one slot per
Price cap	Benchmark B	Listing must be at or below it; the fit test must pass first
Expected orders per listing	Open gap × likely share, as a range with confidence	Conservative end first; a forecast, not a guarantee
Suggested first lot	About 14 days of expected sales, capped at the standard first-lot	In units; no cash figure asked
Committed so far	The ledger, in aggregate only	"Crowded" flag when the gap closes
Pack Point fee	The published fee card	Goes straight into the cost stack
Key dates	Launch calendar	Commitments close day 7; stock at the node by day 18; live days 21–25
Oversubscription	—	The lower listed price wins the slot (keeps allocation on G3)

Launch Week Metrics & Targets

Metric	Formula	Target
Stick rate	Orders per launched listing per day, days 26–30 ÷ median for	≥ 0.5 at day 30; 1.0 by day 60;
Demand lift	Orders per launch listing ÷ comparable listing, launch vs control	≥ 1.5×
Lot sell-through	Units sold ÷ units committed, days 21–25	≥ 60%
Commitment held	Listings that kept price and stock through the window	100%
Price held	Listings at or below B on day 30	High 90s
Description accuracy	"Not as described" ÷ total returns	< 2%
Early reviews	Listings with 2–4 reviews by day 30	Above control

Measuring the launch fairly

- Some districts see the launch section; others do not.
- Outcomes are measured per district: category orders and the price buyers paid.
- Measuring by district stops launch and control listings competing for the same buyers, which would inflate the lift, and it shows whether the launch adds orders to the category or only shifts them.

Appendix - Make-to-Demand Growth Loop

Restock Loop formulas

- **Run-rate** = orders in the trailing 7 days ÷ 7, trend-adjusted on 28 days
- **Reorder point** = run-rate × (lead time + safety days)
- **Next batch** = run-rate × ~21 days, never below the minimum run, capped by the open gap, rounded up to the minimum run.
- **Lead time** = production days + transit to the node (or dispatch readiness if self-shipping); captured once on the bot's quantity screen.

Example: Runrate=11 a day, 84 units on hand, lead time= 5 days, 2 safety days:

- Cover= 7.6 days
- Reorder point= 77 units left
- Next batch 230 (≈ ₹18,400 at cost)
- Landing 29 Nov if started 24 Nov.

Growth Loop Targets

Starting target	Value
Makers active at day 60 / day 90	≥ 70% / ≥ 60%
On a second lot within 45 days	≥ 50%
Forecast attainment at day 30 and	≥ 80%
Stock-outs per launched listing a	≤ 1
Nudges acted on within 7 days	≥ 40%
Fix success within 14 days	≥ 50%
Stopped SKUs replaced within 30	≥ 50%
Makers per category manager	Measured in the pilot; rising launch over

Make to Demand decisions

Make-to-demand verdict	Condition	What happens
Make more	Days of cover below lead time + safety days	Reorder prompt with the dated batch
Keep	In band on sell-through, margin and returns	Nothing; the weekly nudge stays silent
Fix	One metric out of band with a clear cause	The coach's one fix (image, price, trust, product)
Stop	Sell-through below the 25th percentile for 2+ weeks while the	Reorders halt; ledger commitment released;
Switch	After a stop	"What to make instead": open-gap product types that

A category manager is called in only when "launch at risk" persists after the automated fix, or when a maker's listings stay out of band after a fix. Automated actions vs escalations are reported as makers per manager: the pilot measures how many makers one manager can cover rather than assuming it.

Appendix - Levers checked across Gates

Lever	Pain point	Description	Gates passed	Gates failed, and why
Small-lot commitment	Quantity: inventory risk	100–200 units at a locked price with visibility and auto-reorder on success	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
Sale-day launch	Catalog / Volume	Test lots go live together in a dated window	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
Order guarantee	Demand certainty	Meesho promises volume and buys back unsold stock	G2 G3 G4	G1: transfers risk and cost to Meesho
Demand preview	Demand certainty	Category orders a day and price median shown before onboarding	G1 G2 G4	G3: informs, doesn't lower a price
Partner-run logistics	Operations	Partner warehouse packs and ships; Valmo delivers	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
Meesho-enabled listing visit	Product	One-time visit to record SKU material, size and grade	G1 G3 G4	G2 on re-examination: a person per factory
Staff-built catalogs	Product	A central team builds every factory's listings	G1 G3 G4	G2: adds manpower and account managers
Demand-based lot commitment	Quantity: inventory risk	First lot ≈ two weeks of expected orders, in units, made before listing; ledger	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
Partner lending	My cash gets stuck	Inventory loan sized to the lot, deducted from payouts	G2 G3 G4	G1: interest cost scales with volume
Fee waiver for factories	My cash gets stuck	Per-order fees waived for a period	G2 G3 G4	G1: cuts per-order profit, scales with orders
Verification replaces ratings	Catalog / Volume	Verified factories compete on price until stock and quality hold	G1 G3 G4	G2 on re-examination: verification is a visit; redundant once Launch Week gives real orders
Stock-linked visibility	Nobody sees my listing	Visibility follows stock; restocking restores it	G1 G2 G3 G4	– (penalised small lots)
Ad credits for new factories	Nobody sees my listing	Unconditional ad credits or a fixed slice of views	G2 G3	G1: per-order cost; G4: visibility regardless of price
Retrained quality-prediction model	Nobody sees my listing	New sellers judged on orders delivered in 7 days	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
RTO rate per SKU	Returns	Actual refusal and return rates in the cost stack and the coach	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
Platform-funded return risk pool	Returns	Meesho covers courier and buyer-damage losses on returns	G2 G3	G1: a per-order subsidy disguised as protection
Clearance routing for unsold stock	Stock risk	Unsold lots go to deal pages at a price the maker sets	G2 G4	G3: clears at a discount; shelf price unchanged
Like-with-like comparison	Competition	"Cheapest" only within declared material and spec	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
Auto price-hold	Competition: durability	Post-listing price rises remove placement and visibility	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
Manual cost checks	Rejected claims, fees	A team verifies each listing's cost stack	G3 G4	G2: high manpower per listing

39 levers considered:

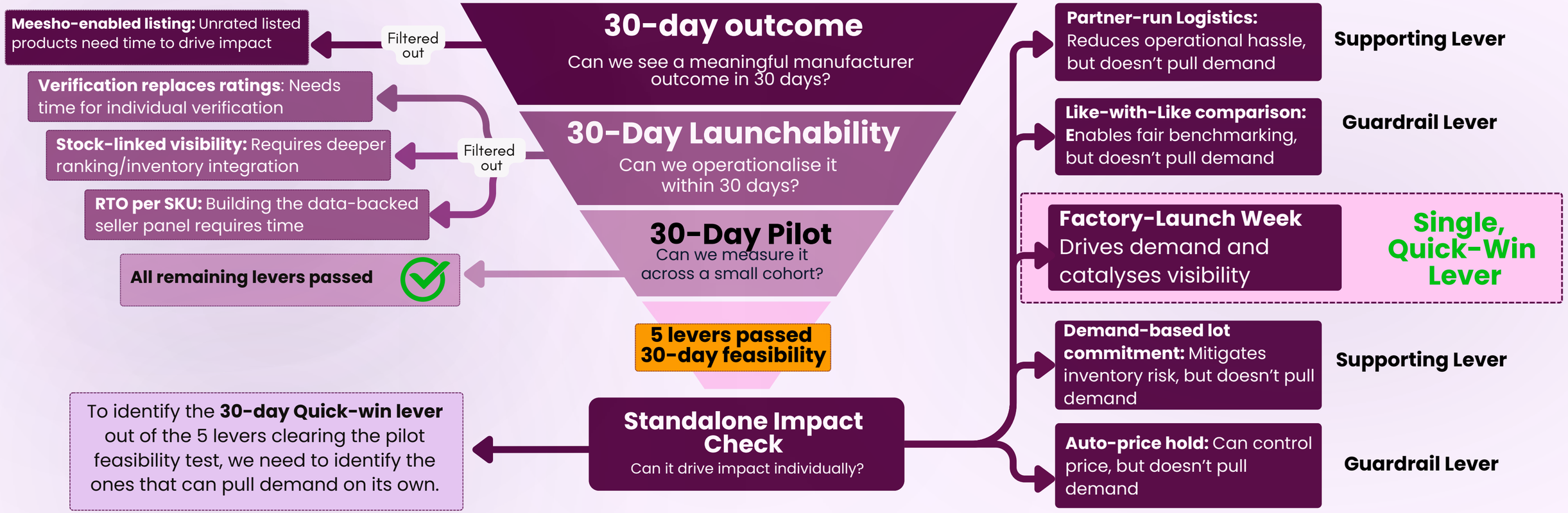
- **The enabler rule:** keeps a lever that fails only G3 when tied to one that passes all four
- **G1 =** Lever must be subsidy-free
- **G2 =** Lever must be scalable(does not require manual handholding)
- **G3 =** Lever should contribute in price-reduction for buyers
- **G4 =** Lever must be durable.

Appendix - Levers checked across Gates

Lever	Pain point	Description	Gates passed	Gates failed, and why
Design copyright window	Competition: copies	Blocks copies of a factory's design for a period	G2 G3	G4: copy detection needs human judgement
Fee shown before shipment	Final payout	Exact fees shown at listing, locked at dispatch	G1 G2 G4	G3: builds trust, changes no price
Meesho pays all disputed claims	Rejected claims	Auto-approve claims for factories	G2	G1: per-order subsidy; G4: encourages false claims
Demand insights (engine)	Demand certainty	Gap sizing, likely-share forecast, "what to make instead", open to every seller	G1 G2 G4	G3: informs, doesn't set a price
Benchmark B & like-for-like	Competition	25th-pct price buyers paid, same spec, per unit, quality floor; spec policing	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
Price band & auto price-hold	Competition; Price	break-even ≤ price ≤ B at listing, held as B moves; cost check at onboarding	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
Targeted outreach with a demand teaser	Awareness	Exit lists, IndiaMART, cluster lists; teaser names the product type and its gap	G1 G2 G4	G3: acquisition, not price
Seller type + automated GST/Udyam checks	Only real makers in launch slots	One sign-up question; records checked automatically	G1 G2 G4	G3: eligibility, not price
AI listing bot	Product; Catalog; Final payout	Product, quantity and price screens; health check; fees locked; price capped at B	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
Cluster Pack Point	Operations	40 makers pooled in one partner node; one lot a week; returns at the node; ₹30 per delivered order	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
Factory Launch Week	Catalog / Volume	30–50 makers live together for five days from a published order book	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
Reorder loop	Restock signal	Reorder point and next batch from the run-rate; zero stock → out of ranked slots	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
SKU health coach	Insight	Funnel diagnosis; one Hindi fix a week; one human step after a failed fix	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
Make to demand	Volume	Stop what isn't selling, switch to what's missing	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
Meesho-only split-able packs	Channels	Pack sizes unique to Meesho, compared per unit	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
Stock-aware pacing	Small lots rank low	Visibility paced to days of cover	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
"Direct from the maker" label	Explaining the low price	A buyer-facing tag on qualifying listings	G1 G2 G3 G4	–
Insight fee (~₹0.40 per order)	Paying for data	Per-order fee on insight-created listings	G1 G2 G4	G3: a fee lowers no price
Cash cap at sign-up	Lot sizing	Maker declares cash they'll commit	G1 G2 G3 G4	–

Filtering for 30-day Quick Win Feasibility

The gates cleared the levers, now filtering them by feasibility to isolate the Quick-win lever for the 30-day pilot



Appendix - Metrics, Risks & Guardrails

Metrics to Track

Owner	Metric	Formula	Starting target
Deck-wide	Price drop delivered	Σ (B − price) × orders ÷ total orders	≥ 8% of B per order by day 90
Engine	Forecast attainment	actual ÷ forecast orders	≥ 60% at day 14, ≥ 80% at day 30
Price layer	Share at or below B; price durability	listings ≤ B ÷ all C2M listings; still ≤ B on day 30	≥ 95%; ≥ 95%
Onboarding	Contact → live; health-check first pass	median days; passes ÷ submissions	≤ 14 days; ≥ 80%
Pack Point	Fee per delivered order; makers pooled	fee ÷ (1 − RTO); count	≤ ₹30; ≥ 40
Launch Week	Stick rate; demand lift; sell-through; NAD	see Launch Week slide	≥ 0.5; ≥ 1.5×; ≥ 60%; < 2%
Growth loop	Makers active at day 90; second lot in 45 days	share of launched makers	≥ 60%; ≥ 50%
Counter-metrics	Category total orders; non-C2M seller exits; refusal cost on C2M listings	launch vs control districts; vs baseline	≥ 1.0 with confidence above 1.0; no rise

Risks & Guardrails

Risk	Early signal	Guardrail
Forecasts over-promise	actual ÷ forecast < 60% by day 14	Low end of every range; no pitch below Medium confidence; weekly recalibration
Everyone chases the same gap	(committed + new supply) ÷ open gap ≥ 90%	Ledger counts new listings; crowded flag; small first lots
Specs cut to hit B	NAD returns ÷ norm ≥ 1.5×	Visibility cut; test buys
Cold outreach breaks opt-in rules	block rate > 1%	IndiaMART or email first; WhatsApp after opt-in
Resellers pose as makers	record mismatch > 10%	Not launch-eligible; B is hard for traders to hit
Pack Point under density	makers pooled < 40	Launch 2 waits; variable-cost partner; self-ship stays
Stock sits at the node	dwell > 45 days	Day-31 storage charge; day-60 forced decision; make to demand
Makers drift after the launch	stick rate at the control group's level	Loop from day 26; switch, not exit
Launch traffic inflates the lift	lift measured against competing listings	District-level control; category orders as the outcome

Appendix - References & Sources

Source	What it supports	Link
Meesho Limited, Updated DRHP (BSE filing, Oct 2025)	183.4 Cr placed orders FY25; category mix; ₹8.09 contribution per order; ₹51.17 charged vs ₹43.1 cost; COD/prepaid success rates (blended RTO 17.8%); AOV; seller count; Redseer industry section (unbranded >75% of retail, 25–30% of e-commerce GMV;	bseindia.com
Meesho Limited, Abridged Prospectus (Nov 2025)	RHP salient features; offer timeline	investmentbank.kotak.com
IPO Central, Meesho IPO key points	Category GMV shares: fashion 21–23%, home & kitchen 23–25%, BPC 8–10%	ipocentral.in
MediaNama, Meesho Q4 FY26 results (May 2026)	FY26 NMV ₹41,560 Cr; 1,710M delivered orders; AOV ₹265; 264M ATU	medianama.com
Meesho blog, Maha Indian Savings Sale (June 2022)	~1 lakh participating sellers, ~26,000 new; ~217% more orders for participants	meesho.io
Udyam Registration Portal / MSME dashboard	4.72 Cr MSMEs; 4,91,064 small enterprises; state and activity breakdowns	dashboard.msme.gov.in
Rajya Sabha reply via Kashmir Life (Aug 2026)	9.16 Cr Udyam registrations; 1.83 Cr manufacturing; 5.41 L small, 41,722 medium	kashmirlife.net
Ministry of MSME, Notification S.O. 1364(E) and circular	MSME reclassification from 1 Apr 2025: small = ≤ ₹25 Cr investment, ≤ ₹100 Cr turnover	udyamregistration.gov.in
Annual Survey of Industries 2023–24 (RBI Handbook, Table 116)	2,60,061 registered factories	website.rbi.org.in
PIB factsheet, 56th GST Council (Sep 2025)	GST 12% → 5% on kitchenware, footwear ≤ ₹2,500, textiles, handicrafts; effective 22 Sep 2025	pib.gov.in
CBIC Notification 09/2025-Central Tax (Rate)	The rate schedule itself	taxo.online
The Report Cubes, India Apparel & Footwear Market	USD 88 bn (2025) apparel and footwear market	thereportcubes.com
IMARC Group, India Footwear Market	Footwear market size and online channel share	imarcgroup.com
Shiprocket Fulfillment, pricing	₹24 per order at 500–3,000 monthly orders; 30-day free storage	fulfillment.shiprocket.in
WareIQ, Meesho order fulfilment	3PL with direct Meesho integration; 20+ FCs	wareiq.com
Eshopbox, Meesho integration via Unicommerce	3PL packing to Meesho spec; video-verified processing	eshopbox.com
Prozo	Fulfilment network, 50+ FCs; ProOMS	prozo.com
Valmo (Meesho logistics)	Partner network for first, middle and last mile; no storage	valmo.in
Kirana Club, FMCG distributor and retailer margins	Distributor, wholesaler and retailer margin bands behind the ₹72 stack	kirana.club
Meesho Supplier Panel	Fee card, Promotions tab, seller onboarding flow	supplier.meesho.com
IndiaMART	Manufacturer directory used for outreach lists	indiamart.com
Fibre2Fashion / Kotak Neo (Sep 2026)	Tiruppur exports; US tariff risk on apparel	fibre2fashion.com
Team RK primary research and models (internal)	Recorded seller call; mentor requirements call; Pack Point cost model (Excel); benchmark B spreadsheet	Team_RK_PackPoint_Cost_Model